

Nikos Vasileiadis

Engineering Leader · Leeds, England, United Kingdom · British Citizen

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Top skills

- **Engineering Leadership & People Development:** Proven track record of building, mentoring, and retaining high-performing remote teams (100% retention rate) while driving 3 promotions through evidence-based cases. Natural aptitude for understanding people, building trust, and creating the conditions for autonomous, high-quality delivery.
- **Organisational Design & Change Management:** Experienced in navigating complex restructurings, building teams from scratch, and shaping team structures that align engineering capability with business outcomes. Have built the same team twice from zero.
- **Platform & Infrastructure Strategy:** Architecting and managing critical platform services and dependencies with a focus on SLAs, SLIs, and operational excellence for 15+ engineering teams.
- **Design Systems Leadership:** End-to-end experience building and managing Design Systems — from open-source implementation (Pulsar at Jadu) to leading a dedicated Design Systems team at scale, enabling consistent, high-velocity delivery across product and engineering.
- **Commercial Engineering & Business Acumen:** Treating engineering as a business lever, not a cost centre. Active contributor to CapEx/OpEx planning, vendor ROI evaluation, and ensuring every technical investment maps to a business outcome.

About

Engineering leader with 20+ years in technology and 9 years of progressive leadership. I started in code — frontend, full-stack, CMS architecture, platform engineering — and mastered the craft. What I discovered along the way is that my real strength is people: building teams, developing talent, creating clarity, and designing the organisational conditions where engineers do their best work.

My leadership arc has grown continuously since 2017: from Scrum Master rotations at Jadu and Leeds Building Society, to bootstrapping and leading the Content Capability team at Utility Warehouse, to managing multiple teams (8 engineers at peak) across Content Capability and Design Systems. Through three restructurings, I now lead a specialist 3-person team covering six critical platform services across the uw.co.uk estate — having built the same team from scratch twice.

I treat engineering as a business lever — contributing to CapEx/OpEx planning, evaluating vendor ROI, and ensuring technical investments map directly to business outcomes. My technical depth gives me credibility with engineers; my focus on people, process, and organisational design is where I create the most value.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Company: Utility Warehouse

Dates: Jul 2023 – Present (2 yrs 3 mos)

Location: United Kingdom · Remote

Employment Type: Full-time

Responsibilities:

- **Team Leadership, Retention & Developing Talent:** Built and managed up to 8 engineers across two teams with a 100% retention rate — maintained through three company restructurings that progressively reduced headcount to a specialist core of 2 engineers, including a pillar move from Customer Experience to Partner. Every reduction was organisational; zero attrition. Drove 3 promotions through evidence-based cases — from Associate to Mid-level and Mid-level to Senior — advocating for talent recognition across organisational boundaries. Mentored engineers who subsequently moved into Engineering Manager roles — both within UW and externally — developing leadership capability one level above my formal remit.
- **Org Design & Structural Influence:** During restructurings, took on unguided responsibility for scoping and executing team migrations — including the Content Capability team's moves between pillars (Marketing Capability → Content Capability → CMS Team, spanning Platforms, Customer Experience, and Partner pillars) — by independently mapping scope, chasing stakeholder alignment, and building consensus from scratch. Challenged and reversed structural decisions that would have eliminated the Design Systems team, demonstrating strategic influence well above the Engineering Manager remit.
- **Documentation & Knowledge Culture:** Authored over 100 articles of technical documentation — from process guides to architecture decisions — making the team the most thoroughly documented at UW. Started from zero: inherited an undocumented legacy CMS and conducted systematic discovery ("Archeology") to map what existed before building the documentation culture from scratch.
- **Technical Enablement & Upskilling:** Identified capability gaps (e.g. Kubernetes) and closed them through self-directed learning, then trained the team and documented the knowledge for future engineers. Pushed team members to take ownership of RFCs, technical presentations, and cross-team knowledge-sharing — developing engineers who could operate independently across the full platform stack.
- **Hiring & Talent Acquisition:** Involved in the end-to-end hiring of 3 external engineers and facilitated 4 internal transfers, contributing to recruitment decisions, candidate assessment, and onboarding.
- **Continuous Leadership Development:** Completed extensive formal management training covering executive-level competencies, including Performance Accountability, Goal Setting for Leaders, Driving Team Results, and Managing Underperformance & Conduct.
- **Rebranding Programme (2 quarters; 500 pages shipped):** Delivered UW's company-wide brand refresh across the full uw.co.uk estate — the primary digital entry point for customers, partners, and the subscriber account system, and the platform where all A/B tests and business tracking metrics run. Our delivery was the critical path: no other team's rebranding work could go live until the main website shipped. Authored automated migration scripts that saved content editors hundreds of manual hours.
- **Platform Reliability & Analytics Ownership:** Maintained 100% uptime on uw.co.uk (SLO: 99.99%) with <3s page load times on critical-path pages and ≤2 incidents per year, all resolved within hours. Supported 15 dependent teams across Customer Marketing, Digital Marketing, Partner Marketing, Acquisition, Data Science, Recruitment, and more. Owns the full platform analytics and compliance stack: Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, and OneTrust — six platform services monitored via Kubernetes, Sentry, Prometheus, Pingdom, and Cloudflare.
- **Design Systems (Hearth) — 20 teams, company-wide adoption:** Led adoption of the Hearth Design System across 20 engineering and product teams (15 full adoption, 5 partial). Consolidating component work at the Design System level eliminated thousands of hours of duplicated engineering effort — at £35+/hour, savings at rebrand scale reached into the hundreds of thousands.
- **CMS Transformation (Apostrophe → Contentful):** Led the end-to-end replacement of an effectively abandoned legacy CMS (no SLA, no SSO, dead tech stack). Conducted rigorous 2-month

evaluation across 10 vendors, shortlisted to 3, and selected Contentful. Executed a zero-disruption dual-serve migration; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained content scheduling, structured content models, and eliminated duplication — removing major technical debt.

- **Adaptability Under Constraints (2025–Present):** Following restructurings that reduced the team to 2 engineers, stepped across role boundaries — absorbing Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside Engineering Management — to sustain delivery across 6 platform services with a 2-person team, while maintaining 100% team retention, 100% platform uptime, and full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

Lead Software Engineer

Company: Utility Warehouse

Dates: May 2022 - Jul 2023 (1 yr 3 mos)

Location: United Kingdom · Remote

Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Joined a standalone team with no formal department, no established processes, and no documentation — built to leverage my cross-functional expertise in engineering, UX, and Agile delivery. A pattern I would repeat in 2025 when forming the specialist CMS Team from a larger restructuring.

- **Team Building from Zero:** Joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing — no department, no precedent. Grew the team from 3 to 6+ through recruitment and internal transfers. The team survived three company-wide restructurings (Marketing Capability → Content Capability → CMS Team) — a mark of its embedded value to the business.
- **Engineering Rigour from Scratch:** Established a fully operational Scrum environment with structured backlog, measurable velocity, and predictable delivery — filling Product Manager gaps when needed and transforming a nascent capability into a reliable engineering team. Conducted systematic discovery ("Archeology") on the legacy Apostrophe CMS, authored the team's foundational documentation, and set the standard that would grow into 100+ articles of process and technical documentation.
- **CMS Strategy & Decision:** Led the evaluation process that resulted in UW's adoption of Contentful as its enterprise CMS. Presented findings and audit trail to leadership; recommendation accepted and implemented.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

Company: IMA-HOME

Dates: Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 (2 yrs 4 mos)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom

Employment Type: Full-time, Hybrid

Description: Operated as a dual-threat technical leader for global brands (Adidas, MARS). Alongside architecting frontend solutions, I formally took on Scrum Master responsibilities to elevate the organization's delivery standards and project predictability.

Agile Transformation: Introduced structured Agile/Scrum practices to an agency running entirely on ad-hoc, fire-driven delivery. Result: measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos — improving delivery health and client confidence across the board.

Global Design Systems (Royal Canin / MARS): Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's global web presence — a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support. Served traffic in the millions.

Projects: Adidas, MARS, Gregg Wallace, Leeds Rhinos, Royal Canin

Senior Digital Developer

Company: Leeds Building Society

Dates: Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 (1 yr 4 mos)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom · Hybrid

Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Maintained public-facing digital assets in a highly regulated FinTech environment while actively mentoring engineering teams to elevate code quality and UX standards.

Agile First Mover: Introduced Agile and Scrum to LBS for the first time, shifting a high-bureaucracy, low-velocity organisation from ad-hoc output to sprint-based iterative delivery with measurable velocity. Served as the unofficial internal Agile champion throughout my tenure.

Digital Transformation (Interim Scrum Master, Jun–Oct 2019): Appointed to lead the Digital Transformation programme alongside external consultants and cross-functional teams — moving from firefighting culture to structured, iterative feature development with regular delivery cadences.

UX Interface Developer

Company: Jadu

Dates: Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 (1 yr 10 mos)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom · Hybrid

Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Designed UIs and developed new features with a strict focus on user experience, accessibility, and W3C standards for an award-winning custom CMS used by Local Authorities, Higher Education, and third-sector organisations.

Design Systems: Co-created and maintained **Pulsar** — an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is the foundation of my Design Systems specialism, combining component architecture, accessibility, and cross-team enablement.

Agile Delivery: Gained foundational, hands-on Agile leadership experience through a rotating Scrum Master model, facilitating sprint planning, daily standups, and embedding the core principles of the Agile manifesto into the team's workflow.

UX Research & End-to-End Feature Ownership: Owned the full feature lifecycle for the CMS product — conducting regular on-site contextual inquiry at client organisations (Wyre Council, Rotherham Council, Greater Manchester Combined Authority, City of York Council, University of Leeds), distilling field research into reports that shaped the product roadmap, and iterating from mockups through usability testing to production release. Operated as one of three product-area leads (CMS, Forms, CRM), each independently responsible for their domain.

Projects: Award-winning custom CMS for large-scale public sector institutions — Open source Interface Design System ([Pulsar](#))

Digital Developer

Company: DS.Emotion

Dates: Oct 2016 - Nov 2016 (2 months)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom

Employment Type: Contract, On-site

Description: Delivered high-performance frontend solutions for premium real estate and automotive clients (e.g., Silverstone).

- **Performance Optimization:** Spearheaded critical performance optimizations across a portfolio of existing projects, significantly improving load times and user engagement metrics.
- **Workflow Modernization:** Championed the transition to modern deployment lifecycles and structured version control (Git), establishing more reliable and efficient engineering workflows for the agency.

Projects: Silverstone, Bowcliffe Hall, St. Leonard's Place, Woodside Square, Sixteen Real Estate

Front-end Developer

Company: Creode

Dates: Oct 2015 - Sep 2016 (1 year)

Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom **Employment Type:** Full-time, On-site

Description: Engineered responsive e-commerce solutions for major retail brands (Vivienne Westwood, Kärcher).

- **E-Commerce Delivery:** Collaborated cross-functionally to bring complex UI designs to life, ensuring seamless cross-browser compatibility and strict adherence to brand standards.
- **Digital Marketing Support:** Developed robust architecture for high-conversion HTML email campaigns, directly supporting the agency's retention and sales generation strategies.

Projects: Vivienne Westwood, Kärcher, CACI, EQVVS, G-Type

Early Career & Consulting

Dates: Oct 2005 - Sep 2015 (10 years) **Description:** Various full-stack development, consultancy, and training roles building the foundation of my technical and leadership capabilities. Key experiences included developing CMS-based solutions for non-profits (UNESCO) and local businesses, architecting real estate platforms, engineering e-commerce splits payment systems, and delivering technical training (C Programming, Algorithms).

Education

Institution: freeCodeCamp — Computer Software Engineering

Institution: IxDF - The Interaction Design Foundation — User Experience and Interaction Design (2017–2020)

Institution: International University of Greece - Serres Campus

Degree: BSc Informatics Engineering (attended 2007–2012; did not graduate due to the Greek financial crisis)

Professional Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026

Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023

Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022–2023

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full certifications list — *Scrum, UX, FinTech, analytics, cloud, accessibility, and more* — available on the [Professional Development](#) page.

Community & Leadership

Mentor, WRK digital (*Feb 2023–Present*): Mentored engineers who progressed into Engineering Manager roles (both within UW and externally). Peer mentoring network spanning Engineering Managers, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code (*Aug–Jan 2024*): Supported early-career engineers entering the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds (*Jan 2019–Mar 2020*): Revived an inactive GDG chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and technical meetups.